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DIGITAL LITERACY PROJECT REPORT

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INTRODUCTION

Digital literacy is an essential skill for students in today's technology-driven world. It is not limited to using computers or mobile phones, but also includes the ability to communicate professionally, use digital platforms responsibly, stay safe online, and build a useful online presence. This project was designed to help students understand and apply important digital literacy skills in practical ways.

As part of this assignment, I completed five tasks based on different modules of the course. These tasks included creating an infographic, setting up professional digital profiles, exploring online collaboration and coding platforms, writing formal emails, and studying cybercrime awareness. Through this project, I learned how digital tools can support academics, communication, professional growth, and online safety. Overall, this project helped me improve both my technical understanding and my responsible use of digital platforms.

Task 1 – Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

For Task 1, I used icons, short bullet points, and a blue-themed layout to make the infographic simple and student-friendly. on the topic **“Digital Literacy for College Students”** using **Canva**. I selected Canva because it is a user-friendly and visually appealing design tool that provides many templates, icons, and layout options. My infographic was designed to spread awareness among students about the importance of digital literacy in academic and professional life.

In my infographic, I included five major areas: **what digital literacy means, useful digital tools for students, safe internet practices, professional online presence, and email etiquette**. I explained that digital literacy means using online tools and digital platforms effectively, safely, and responsibly. I also included examples of useful student tools such as GitHub, Google Docs, LinkedIn, and Canva. For online safety, I added points such as using strong passwords, avoiding suspicious links, and never sharing OTPs. I also highlighted the importance of maintaining a professional online image and writing polite emails.

The most interesting part of this task was turning theoretical ideas into a visual format that could be easily understood by students. The difficult part was selecting the most important points and arranging them neatly within a single page. Overall, this task helped me understand how awareness content can be made informative and engaging through design.

Task 2 – Build Your Student Digital Portfolio

For Task 2, I created or updated my profiles on three professional and academic platforms: **GitHub**, **LinkedIn**, and **Stack Overflow**. These platforms are useful for students because they help in building a digital identity, showcasing skills, and exploring future opportunities. This task helped me understand that having a professional online presence is important even in the early years of college.

On **GitHub**, I created my profile README and added basic details such as my name, branch, year, and a short statement about what I hope to learn during my academic journey. GitHub is useful for storing projects, code, documents, and portfolios. On **LinkedIn**, I created a professional student profile and updated the Education section with my current degree, institution name, and expected graduation year. LinkedIn is mainly used for professional networking, internships, and career opportunities. On **Stack Overflow**, I created a profile to explore data science and machine learning communities. Although I am just beginning, I understand that it can be useful in future academic and technical learning.

Over the next four years, I plan to use GitHub for storing projects and academic work, LinkedIn for networking and internships, and Stack Overflow for learning and improving technical skills. This task made me realize that building a strong digital portfolio should start early in college.

Task 3 – Explore Coding & Collaboration Platforms

For Task 3, I worked with two different types of digital platforms: a **coding practice platform** and a **Google Workspace collaboration tool**. This task was useful because it introduced me to both technical practice and online academic collaboration.

For **Part A**, I created an account on **HackerRank** and the beginner challenge helped me understand how coding platforms test logic, syntax, and problem-solving step by step. I selected an easy beginner problem because the main aim was to understand how coding practice platforms work. Solving even a simple challenge helped me understand how these websites are structured, how coding questions are presented, and how students can use them to improve their problem-solving skills over time. Such platforms are very useful for interview preparation, coding practice, and skill development.

For **Part B**, I created a **Google Form** titled “**Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz**” with exactly five questions. The form included both multiple-choice and short-answer questions related to digital literacy, online safety, and professional communication. I also linked the form to **Google Sheets** to understand how responses are automatically collected and organized. This was very helpful in understanding how online forms can be used for surveys, quizzes, and academic data collection.

This task showed me that digital platforms are not only for coding but also for collaboration, awareness-building, and information management. These tools can be very helpful throughout academic life for learning, organizing, and communicating effectively.

Task 4 – Draft a Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

Task 4 focused on **digital communication and professional etiquette**, especially in the context of email writing and responsible social media use. In this task, I wrote two formal emails and created a checklist of social media Do's and Don'ts for students.

The first email was written from a student to a professor requesting an extension for an assignment submission. The second email was written to an internship coordinator expressing interest in a summer internship opportunity. While writing these emails, I understood the importance of a **clear subject line, respectful greeting, well-structured body, and proper sign-off**. This task helped me learn that professional communication should always be polite, concise, and purposeful.

A common situation where poor digital communication can create problems is when a student sends an unclear or rude email to a professor without a subject line, proper greeting, or respectful tone. This can create a negative impression and may also delay the response. Such situations can be avoided by using proper email etiquette, checking grammar, and maintaining professionalism in online communication. I also created a simple social media checklist to spread awareness about responsible digital behaviour among students. Overall, this task helped me understand that communication skills are just as important as technical skills in the digital world.

Task 5 – Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention Guide

For Task 5, I chose the topic **UPI and Online Payment Fraud** because it is highly relevant to students in India and is one of the most common forms of cybercrime today. This task helped me understand how cybercriminals misuse digital platforms and how ordinary users can become victims if they are not careful.

In the case study, I explained that UPI fraud often begins with fake calls, suspicious links, QR code scams, OTP requests, or unauthorized collect requests. Fraudsters usually create urgency and try to make the victim panic or act quickly. Students are especially vulnerable because they frequently use digital payment apps for food, shopping, travel, and peer transactions. I also described the consequences of such fraud, including financial loss, stress, and misuse of personal data.

The most surprising thing I learned while researching this topic was how easily a small mistake, such as sharing an OTP or approving the wrong payment request, can lead to serious consequences. One personal habit I will change as a result of this task is that I will always verify every payment request carefully before approving it. I also created a prevention checklist with practical online safety tips, including UPI safety measures and the official reporting channels such as the **National Cyber Crime Portal** and **Helpline 1930**. As a cybersecurity student, this topic was especially relevant because it showed how common digital fraud affects everyday users of digital safety.

Conclusion:

This Digital Literacy Project was a practical and meaningful learning experience. It helped me understand that digital literacy is not only about using technology, but also about using it **safely, responsibly, and professionally**. Through the five tasks, I learned how to create awareness content, build a professional online presence, use learning and collaboration platforms, communicate through formal emails, and stay safe from cybercrime.

The project also showed me that digital skills are essential for academic success, career development, and personal safety. Each task contributed to a different area of digital awareness and gave me useful knowledge that I can apply in my daily life as a student. Overall, this project improved both my confidence and understanding in the digital world.

References:

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